

100 Looker Studio Question & Answers

1. What is Looker Studio?

Looker Studio is a cloud-based business intelligence tool used to convert raw data into visual dashboards and reports. Looker studio is an advanced version of Google Data Studio with some additional features.

It connects to multiple data sources such as spreadsheets, databases, and analytics platforms. The tool helps users analyze trends using charts, graphs, and tables. Reports are interactive and can be shared easily. It is widely used for marketing, sales, and performance reporting.

Practical Example:

A company connects Google Analytics 4 to create a dashboard showing daily website visitors and conversions.

2. What are the main features of Looker Studio?

- Looker Studio provides features such as data visualization, dashboard creation, and real-time reporting.
- It supports multiple data connectors and interactive filters. Users can blend data from different sources.
- Reports can be shared with teams or embedded on websites. It also supports calculated fields and custom visualizations.

Example:

Creating a marketing dashboard combining website traffic and advertising data.

3. What is a data source in Looker Studio?

A data source is the system from which Looker Studio retrieves data for analysis. It acts as the connection between stored data and the report.

Data sources contain fields such as dimensions and metrics. They allow dashboards to display updated information automatically.

Example:

Connecting Google Sheets containing monthly sales data.

4. Difference between Looker Studio and Tableau

Looker Studio is a free, cloud-based reporting tool mainly used for quick dashboards. Tableau is a powerful enterprise-level BI tool with advanced analytics features.

Looker Studio is easier to learn but has fewer advanced capabilities. Tableau supports deeper data modeling and offline analysis.

Example:

Small businesses prefer Looker Studio for marketing dashboards.

5. Difference between Looker Studio and Power BI

Looker Studio integrates strongly with Google services and works entirely online. Power BI integrates with Microsoft products and has a desktop application.

Power BI offers stronger data modeling features. Looker Studio focuses more on easy visualization and sharing.

Example:

Companies using Google ecosystem prefer Looker Studio.

6. What are advantages of Looker Studio?

Looker Studio is free, easy to use, and cloud-based. It connects to many data sources and supports interactive dashboards. Reports can be shared instantly through links. It allows collaboration among team members. It is widely used for digital marketing reporting.

Example:

Marketing teams track campaign performance in real time.

7. What types of data sources can Looker Studio connect to?

Looker Studio can connect to spreadsheets, databases, and cloud services.

Common connectors include Google Analytics, BigQuery, and MySQL.

It also supports partner connectors for marketing tools. These connections allow dashboards to pull data automatically.

Example:

Connecting Google BigQuery for large datasets.

8. What is a report in Looker Studio?

A report is a collection of visualizations such as charts, tables, and scorecards created from data sources. Reports are used to present insights and performance metrics.

They can contain multiple pages and interactive elements. Reports can also be shared with viewers.

Example:

Monthly business performance report.

9. What is a dashboard?

A dashboard is a visual summary of key business metrics in one interface.

It displays charts and KPIs to help users monitor performance. Dashboards simplify complex datasets into easy visuals. They are interactive with filters and date controls.

Example:

Sales dashboard showing revenue and orders.

10. What is data blending?

Data blending combines data from multiple sources into one dataset. It allows analysts to compare and analyze information from different systems. Blending uses a common field called a join key. This feature helps create more comprehensive reports.

Example:

Combining marketing data with sales data.

11. What are dimensions?

Dimensions are categorical fields that describe data.

They provide context for numerical metrics.

Dimensions group data into meaningful categories.

They are usually text, date, or location values.

Example:

Country, Product Name, Date.

12. What are metrics?

Metrics are numerical values used to measure performance.

They represent measurable quantities such as totals or averages.

Metrics are often aggregated using functions like SUM or COUNT. They are analyzed together with dimensions.

Example:

Sales amount, number of users.

13. What is a scorecard?

A scorecard is a visualization that displays a single key metric. It highlights important performance indicators in dashboards. Scorecards often show comparisons with previous periods.

Example:

Total Revenue = ₹50,000.

14. What is a filter?

A filter limits the data shown in a chart or report. It helps focus on specific data segments. Filters can be applied at chart, page, or report level. They make dashboards interactive.

Example:

Show sales only from India.

15. What are date range controls?

Date range controls allow users to change the time period of the report.

They help analyze trends over different time ranges. Users can select predefined ranges like last 7 days or custom dates.

Example:

Viewing website traffic for the last month.

Data Sources & Charts (16–40)

16. How do you connect data sources in Looker Studio?

Users connect data sources by selecting a connector and authorizing access. After connection, fields from the source appear in the report editor.

These fields can be used in charts and tables. This process links the dataset to the dashboard.

Example:

Connecting a spreadsheet to display sales data.

17. What are Google connectors?

Google connectors are built-in integrations with Google services.

They allow easy access to Google-based data sources. These connectors simplify data integration.

Example:

Google Analytics connector.

18. What are partner connectors?

Partner connectors are third-party integrations that connect Looker Studio with external platforms. They allow importing data from marketing or CRM tools.

Example:

Facebook Ads connector.

19. How do you connect Google Sheets to Looker Studio?

Users select the Google Sheets connector and choose the desired spreadsheet. After authorization, the sheet becomes the data source. Fields are automatically detected. The data can then be used to create charts.

20. How do you connect BigQuery to Looker Studio?

Users select the BigQuery connector and choose the project, dataset, and table. Looker Studio then imports the schema. Data can be visualized directly in reports.

21. What is the Extract Data connector?

The Extract Data connector stores a cached version of the dataset in Looker Studio. It improves performance by reducing repeated queries. Extracted data refreshes periodically.

22. What is the difference between live connection and extract data?

Live connection retrieves data directly from the source each time the report loads.

Extract data stores a copy for faster performance. Live connection provides real-time updates. Extracted data improves speed for large datasets.

23. What happens if a data source schema changes?

If fields are renamed or removed in the source, charts may break in the report.

Users must refresh fields or update the report configuration. Maintaining consistent schema prevents errors.

24. How do you refresh data in Looker Studio?

Users refresh data through the data source settings. Looker Studio also refreshes data automatically depending on the connector. This ensures dashboards stay updated.

25. How do you edit a data source?

Data sources can be edited from the resource menu. Users can rename fields, change data types, or create calculated fields.

Editing helps customize data for reporting.

Charts & Visualization (31–50)

26. What types of charts are available in Looker Studio?

Looker Studio provides many visualization types to analyze data.

Common charts include bar chart, line chart, pie chart, table, scorecard, geo map, scatter chart, and pivot table.

Charts help convert complex data into easy visual insights.

Choosing the correct chart improves understanding of trends and comparisons.

Example

Bar chart → Compare sales by product

Line chart → Show monthly sales trend

27. What is a Time Series Chart?

A time series chart shows how data changes over time. It uses a date or time dimension on the horizontal axis.

It helps identify patterns, trends, and growth over time.

It is commonly used for tracking performance metrics.

Example

Date	Visitors
Jan 1	100
Jan 2	150
Jan 3	200

Shows daily traffic growth.

28. What is a Bar Chart?

A bar chart displays data using rectangular bars. Each bar represents a category and its value.

It is mainly used for comparing categories.

It can be vertical or horizontal.

Example

Product	Sales
Laptop	500
Mobile	700

Bar chart compares sales by product.

29 What is a Pie Chart?

A pie chart represents data as slices of a circle. Each slice shows the percentage contribution of a category.

It is useful for understanding distribution of data.

Best used when there are few categories.

Example

Traffic sources:

Organic – 50%

Direct – 30%

Social – 20%

30. What is a Geo Map Chart?

- A geo map visualizes data based on geographic locations.
- Locations such as countries, states, or cities can be displayed.
- Color intensity usually represents the value of the metric.
- Useful for analyzing regional performance.

Example

Sales by country:

India – 500

USA – 300

Displayed on a world map.

31. What is a Table Chart?

A table chart displays data in rows and columns. It shows detailed records instead of summarized visuals.

Tables support sorting, filtering, and multiple metrics.

Example

Product	Sales	Profit
Laptop	2000	500

32. What is a Pivot Table?

A pivot table summarizes data across multiple dimensions. It organizes data using rows and columns.

It helps compare relationships between categories.

Useful for analyzing large datasets.

Example

Product

East

West

Laptop

100

200

Shows regional sales comparison.

33. What is a Scorecard Chart?

A scorecard shows a single important metric value. It highlights key performance indicators (KPIs). Scorecards may also display percentage change over time.

Usually placed at the top of dashboards.

Example

Scorecard shows:

Total Revenue = ₹1,50,000

34. What is a Scatter Chart?

A scatter chart displays the relationship between two numeric variables. Each point represents one record in the dataset.

It helps identify patterns, correlations, or clusters.

Often used in statistical analysis.

Example

Plot showing:

Advertising Budget (X-axis)

Sales Revenue (Y-axis)

35. What is a Treemap Chart?

A treemap displays hierarchical data using rectangles. The size of each rectangle represents the value of a metric.

It helps compare proportions within categories.

Useful when there are many categories.

Example

Revenue by product category:

Electronics

Clothing

Accessories

36. What is a Bullet Chart?

- A bullet chart compares actual performance against a target value.
- It displays progress toward a goal.
- It is commonly used for KPI tracking.
- Helps evaluate performance quickly.

Example

Sales target = ₹50,000

Actual sales = ₹42,000

37. What is an Area Chart?

- An area chart shows trends over time similar to a line chart.
- The area under the line is filled with color.
- It helps visualize volume changes across time periods.
- Useful for showing cumulative totals.

Example

Monthly revenue growth chart.

38. How do you add charts in Looker Studio?

Steps:

- Open the report editor.
- Click Add Chart from the toolbar.
- Choose the chart type.
- Select dimension and metric fields.
- Customize the chart style.

Practical Example

Add a bar chart showing sales by product.

39. How do you customize chart styles?

- Select the chart in the report.
- Open the Style panel.
- Modify colors, fonts, and labels.
- Adjust axis, gridlines, and chart layout.

Example

Change chart color to highlight top-performing products.

40. What is Chart Interaction?

- Chart interaction allows users to interact with dashboard visuals.
- Users can hover over data points to see details.
- Clicking charts may filter other charts automatically.
- It makes dashboards dynamic.

Example

Clicking India in a map filters all charts to Indian data.

41. How do you sort data in charts?

Select the chart, Choose the Sort option in chart settings, Select a field to sort by, Choose ascending or descending order.

Example

Sort products by highest sales first.

42. How do you limit rows in charts?

Open chart properties, Use the Row Limit setting, Set the number of rows to display.

Useful for showing top results.

Example

Display Top 10 products by revenue.

43. What is Drill Down functionality?

Drill-down allows users to view deeper levels of data. It uses hierarchical dimensions.

Users click a category to explore detailed levels.

Example

Country → State → City.

44. What are Optional Metrics?

Optional metrics allow users to change the metric shown in a chart. It provides flexibility for analysis.

Users select metrics dynamically from a dropdown.

Example

Switch between:

Revenue

Profit

Orders.

45. What is Chart Filtering?

- Chart filtering restricts data displayed in a chart.
- Filters can include or exclude certain values.
- It helps focus on specific data segments.

Example

Show only sales from 2025.

46. What is a Calculated Field in Looker Studio?

A Calculated Field is a custom field created using a formula inside Looker Studio. It allows analysts to generate new metrics or dimensions from existing data fields. These formulas can include mathematical operations, logical conditions, and functions. Calculated fields help perform analysis without modifying the original data source. They are commonly used to calculate profit, percentage growth, or custom categories.

Example

Dataset:

Revenue	Cost
1000	700

Calculated Field Formula:

Profit = Revenue - Cost

Result:

Profit = 300

47. How do you create a Calculated Field in Looker Studio?

Calculated fields are created in the data source editor. First open the report and go to Resource → Manage added data sources. Then select the data source and click Add a Field. Write the formula using Looker Studio functions and operators. After saving, the new field becomes available for charts and tables.

Example

Formula to calculate Total Revenue

Total Revenue = Price * Quantity

Dataset:

Price	Quantity
200	5

Result = 1000

48. What are Calculated Field formulas?

Calculated field formulas are expressions used to transform or compute data inside Looker Studio.

They combine existing fields using functions, operators, and conditional logic.

These formulas help analysts derive meaningful insights from raw data.

Many functions similar to SQL or spreadsheet formulas are supported.

They can calculate totals, averages, percentages, or conditional values.

Example

Formula for Average Sales

Average Sales = SUM(Sales) / COUNT(Sales)

This helps calculate average sales per transaction.

49. What is a CASE Statement?

Answer

A CASE statement is used to create conditional categories in data.

It checks multiple conditions and returns a value based on the result.

CASE statements are useful when we want to group data into meaningful segments.

They work similar to IF–ELSE logic in programming or SQL.

This helps simplify complex datasets for better reporting.

Example

Dataset:

Sales

1200

300

Formula:

CASE

WHEN Sales > 1000 THEN "High Sales"

ELSE "Low Sales"

END

Result:

1200 → High Sales

300 → Low Sales

50. What is the IF Function?

The IF function evaluates a logical condition and returns a value based on whether the condition is true or false.

It is commonly used to categorize data or create conditional calculations.

IF statements are simpler compared to CASE statements for single conditions.

They help analysts quickly identify patterns or performance levels.

This function improves data interpretation in dashboards.

Example

Formula:

IF(Sales > 500, "Good Performance", "Low Performance")

Dataset:

Sales

700

200

Result:

700 → Good Performance

200 → Low Performance

51. What is the CONCAT Function?

CONCAT is used to combine multiple text fields into a single value.

It is useful when we want to merge information like first name and last name.

This function helps create readable labels or identifiers in reports.

It improves the presentation of textual data in dashboards.

CONCAT works similar to text joining in spreadsheets.

Example

Dataset:

First Name

Last Name

Ravi

Kumar

Formula:

CONCAT(First_Name," ",Last_Name)

Result:

Ravi Kumar

52. What is REGEXP_MATCH?

REGEXP_MATCH is used to check whether a text field matches a specific pattern.

It uses regular expressions to detect patterns in strings.

This function is very helpful for data validation and filtering.

Analysts often use it to identify specific email domains or keywords.

It helps categorize text-based data efficiently.

Example

Formula:

REGEXP_MATCH(Email,"gmail.com")

Dataset:

Email

abc@gmail.com

xyz@yahoo.com

Result:

gmail → TRUE

yahoo → FALSE

53. What is the CAST Function?

CAST is used to convert a field from one data type to another.

Sometimes data may be stored incorrectly as text instead of numbers.

Converting the data type ensures accurate calculations and aggregations.

CAST helps maintain data consistency in reports.

It is commonly used when importing data from spreadsheets or external systems.

Example

Dataset:

Sales

"500"

Formula:

CAST(Sales AS NUMBER)

Result:

Text "500" becomes numeric 500.

54. What is DATE_DIFF?

DATE_DIFF calculates the difference between two dates.

It returns the number of days, months, or years between them.

This function is useful for measuring time duration or delays.

Analysts use it to track delivery times, customer lifecycle, or subscription duration.

It supports different time units like DAY, MONTH, and YEAR.

Example

Dataset:

Order Date	Delivery Date
Jan 1	Jan 5

Formula:

DATE_DIFF(Delivery_Date, Order_Date)

Result:

4 days

55. What is the SUM Function?

SUM is an aggregation function used to add all numeric values in a field.

It is commonly used to calculate totals such as revenue, cost, or sales.

SUM helps analysts understand overall performance of a dataset.

It works across multiple records automatically.

This function is frequently used in dashboards and KPI calculations.

Example

Dataset:

Sales
100
200
300

Formula:

SUM(Sales)

Result:

Total Sales = 600

56. What is the AVG Function?

AVG is an aggregation function used to calculate the average value of a numeric field.

It adds all values in a field and divides them by the number of records.

This function helps analysts understand the typical or average performance of data.

AVG is commonly used for metrics like average order value, average revenue, or average rating.

It helps compare performance across different time periods or categories.

Example

Dataset:

Sales

100

200

300

Formula:

AVG(Sales)

Result:

Average Sales = 200

57. What is the COUNT Function?

COUNT is an aggregation function used to calculate the total number of records in a dataset.

It counts all non-null values in a selected field.

This function helps measure dataset size or activity levels.

COUNT is often used for metrics like total orders, total transactions, or total visits.

It helps analysts understand the volume of data being analyzed.

Example

Dataset:

Order ID

101

102

Formula:

COUNT(Order_ID)

Result:

Total Orders = 3

58. What is COUNT DISTINCT?

COUNT DISTINCT counts the number of unique values in a dataset.

Unlike COUNT, it removes duplicate values before counting.

This function is useful when analyzing unique users, customers, or products.

It helps avoid inflated results caused by repeated entries.

Analysts use it frequently in marketing and customer analytics.

Example

Dataset:

Customer

Ravi

Ravi

Amit

Formula:

COUNT_DISTINCT(Customer)

Result:

Unique Customers = 2

59. What is Running Sum?

Running Sum calculates a cumulative total over time.

Each value includes the previous totals plus the current value.

It helps track growth trends and progressive performance.

Running sums are useful for monitoring revenue growth or sales targets.

It is often used in time-series analysis.

Example

Dataset:

Month	Sales
Jan	100
Feb	200
Mar	300

Running Sum:

Jan = 100

Feb = 300

Mar = 600

60. What is Percentage Calculation?

Percentage calculation shows how much a value contributes to the total.

It helps compare relative performance between categories.

Analysts often use percentages to analyze market share, conversion rate, or category distribution.

It provides better understanding than raw numbers alone.

Percentage calculations are widely used in dashboards.

Example

Formula:

$$(\text{Sales} / \text{Total Sales}) * 100$$

Dataset:

Product Sales = 200

Total Sales = 1000

Result:

Contribution = 20%

Filters & Controls

61. What is a Filter Control?

Filter control allows users to interactively filter data in a dashboard.

It gives report viewers the ability to customize the data they see.

Filters can be applied to charts, pages, or entire reports.

They help make dashboards more dynamic and user-friendly.

Common filter controls include dropdowns and date selectors.

Example

A dropdown filter allows users to select:

India

USA

UK

The dashboard updates automatically based on the selection.

62. What are the Types of Filters in Looker Studio?

Answer

Looker Studio provides different types of filters to control data visibility.

These filters help analysts focus on specific datasets.

The most common filters include include filters, exclude filters, and date filters.

Filters can be applied at chart level, page level, or report level.

They help improve analysis accuracy.

Examples of Filters:

- **Include filter**
- **Exclude filter**
- **Date range filter**
- **Page filter**
- **Report filter**

63. What is an Include Filter?

An include filter displays only the selected values in a dataset.

All other values are excluded automatically.

This is useful when analysts want to focus on specific categories.

Include filters simplify large datasets.

They help highlight relevant information.

Example

Filter condition:

Country = India

The chart will show only Indian data.

64. What is an Exclude Filter?

An exclude filter removes specific values from the dataset. All other values remain visible in the report.

This filter is useful when removing unwanted data.

Analysts often exclude test data or invalid records.

It improves data accuracy in reports.

Example

Exclude:

Country = Test Data

All other countries remain visible.

65. What is an Advanced Filter?

Advanced filters allow analysts to apply complex filtering conditions. These filters can include multiple rules or expressions. They are useful for filtering based on ranges or patterns.

Advanced filters help perform more detailed data analysis.

They support logical operators such as AND and OR.

Example

Filter condition:

Sales > 1000

Only high-value transactions appear.

66. What is a Date Range Filter?

A date range filter allows users to select a specific time period. It dynamically updates charts based on the selected dates. This filter is essential for time-based analysis.

It helps track performance across different time ranges.

It is commonly used in marketing and sales dashboards.

Example

User selects:

Last 30 days

All charts show data only for the last 30 days.

67. What is a Dropdown Filter?

A dropdown filter is a control that allows users to choose values from a list. It makes dashboards interactive and easier to navigate.

Dropdown filters are commonly used for selecting dimensions like country or product.

They help users analyze specific categories.

This improves dashboard usability.

Example

Dropdown options:

Electronics

Clothing

Furniture

Selecting Electronics updates all charts.

68. What is Data Control?

Data control allows viewers to change the account used in a data source. It is commonly used with Google products like Google Analytics. This feature allows the same dashboard to work for multiple accounts.

It saves time by avoiding separate dashboards for each account.

It is useful for agencies managing multiple clients.

Example

Switch between:

Google Analytics Account A

Google Analytics Account B

69. What is Parameter Control?

A parameter is a user-defined variable that changes calculations dynamically. It allows viewers to input values into dashboards. These values influence metrics or filters in reports.

Parameters increase dashboard flexibility.

They are useful for scenario analysis.

Example

User selects metric:

Revenue

Profit

Dashboard updates accordingly.

70. What are Interactive Filters?

Interactive filters allow charts to respond to user interactions. Clicking a chart element automatically filters other charts. This makes dashboards more interactive and exploratory.

It helps users quickly drill into specific data segments.

Interactive filters improve the user experience.

Example

Click India in a map → all charts show only Indian data.

Below are the answers in the same format as before: clear explanation in points (about 5–6 lines) + practical example for Looker Studio.

71. How do you apply Filters to Charts in Looker Studio?

Filters are used to control which data appears in a chart. They allow analysts to include or exclude specific records based on conditions.

Filters help focus on relevant data and remove unnecessary information from visualizations. In Looker Studio, filters can be applied directly to an individual chart. This makes analysis more precise and improves dashboard clarity.

Steps to Apply Filter

Select the chart in the report. > Open the Data panel on the right side. > Scroll to the Filter section. > Click Add a Filter. > Choose conditions (Include / Exclude).

Example

Filter condition:

Country = India

Result:

The chart displays only Indian data.

72. What is Cross Filtering?

Cross filtering is a feature that allows charts in a dashboard to interact with each other. When a user clicks on a value in one chart, other charts automatically filter their data.

This helps users explore the dataset dynamically without applying manual filters. Cross filtering makes dashboards more interactive and user-friendly.

It is especially useful for exploring relationships between different dimensions.

Example

Dashboard contains:

Geo Map → Country

Bar Chart → Product Sales

Line Chart → Revenue Trend

User clicks India on the map.

Result:

All charts update to show data only for India.

73. What is a Chart Level Filter?

A chart level filter applies only to a specific chart in a report. It does not affect other charts on the dashboard.

This filter is useful when analysts want one visualization to display a specific subset of data. It allows detailed analysis while keeping the rest of the dashboard unchanged.

Chart-level filters are configured in the chart settings panel.

Example

Dashboard contains:

Sales by Country chart

Sales by Product chart

Chart-level filter applied:

Country = USA

Result:

Sales by Country chart → shows only USA data

Other charts remain unchanged.

74. What is a Page Level Filter?

A page level filter affects all charts on a single page of the dashboard. It ensures that every visualization on that page displays filtered data. This helps maintain consistency in analysis across multiple charts.

Page filters are useful when analyzing data for a specific time period or region. They simplify dashboard interaction for users.

Example

Filter applied on page:

Year = 2024

Result:

All charts on that page display only 2024 data.

75. What is a Report Level Filter?

A report level filter applies to the entire dashboard report across all pages. Every chart in every page follows the same filter condition. This ensures a consistent dataset throughout the entire report.

Report-level filters are useful for restricting dashboards to specific business units or markets. They help maintain data security and relevance.

Example

Report filter applied:

Region = Asia

Result:

All pages in the report show only Asian market data.

Data Blending & Advanced Concepts

76. What is Data Blending?

Data blending combines multiple datasets into a single analysis view. It allows analysts to connect data from different sources. Blending requires a common field called a join key.

It helps analyze relationships between datasets.

Data blending is useful for advanced business insights.

Example

Combine:

Sales data

Marketing spend data

To analyze ROI.

77. Why is Data Blending used?

Data blending allows analysis across multiple data sources. Many organizations store data in separate systems.

Blending helps combine these datasets for deeper insights.

It improves decision making by connecting related data.

It eliminates the need for manual data merging.

Example

Combine:

Ad spend + Sales revenue.

78. What is a Join Key?

A join key is a common field used to connect two datasets. It ensures that records from different tables match correctly. Without a join key, datasets cannot be blended accurately.

Join keys must contain matching values in both datasets.

They are similar to keys used in SQL joins.

Example

Product ID used to join:

Product table + Sales table.

79. What is a Left Join?

A left join keeps all records from the primary dataset. It adds matching records from the secondary dataset. If no match exists, the result shows null values. Left joins are commonly used in Looker Studio blending.

They help maintain the main dataset's structure.

Example

Sales dataset joined with marketing dataset.

80. What are Limitations of Looker Studio?

Looker Studio has limited advanced data modeling features. Large datasets may cause performance issues.

Some complex calculations require external tools like SQL. Data blending supports limited sources.

Custom visualization options are limited compared to advanced BI tools.

Example

Large datasets are better handled in BigQuery before visualization.

Here are short, clear answers with simple meaning for Looker Studio.

81. What Types of Joins are Supported?

In Looker Studio data blending, the main join used is Left Join. It keeps all records from the primary (left) dataset.

Matching records from the secondary dataset are added. If no match exists, the value becomes null.

82. What is Left Join in Blending?

A Left Join keeps all rows from the first dataset. It adds matching rows from the second dataset.

If no match exists, the second dataset fields show null values. It ensures the primary dataset is not lost.

Example

Website traffic data joined with sales data.

83. How Many Data Sources Can Be Blended?

Looker Studio allows blending up to 5 data sources in one blended dataset. These datasets must share a common join key. Using too many sources may affect dashboard speed.

84. What Happens if Keys Don't Match?

When join keys do not match, Looker Studio cannot combine those rows. The result may show null or empty values. Some records may not appear in the blended chart.

Example

Dataset A → Product ID = 101

Dataset B → Product ID = 201

No match → Null values appear.

85. What is a Blended Data Source?

A blended data source is a new dataset created by combining multiple data sources. It merges fields from different datasets using a join key. The blended dataset can then be used in charts or tables.

Example

Combine Ad Spend data + Sales data to analyze marketing performance.

Since IDs are different, Looker Studio shows null values after blending.

86. How Do You Create a Blended Data Source?

Data blending is created directly inside the Looker Studio report editor.

First select a chart and click Blend Data in the data panel.

Then select multiple data sources and define the join key.

Choose the dimensions and metrics from each dataset.

Save the blend and use it in visualizations.

Example

Join key:

Date

Combine:

Website traffic data

Sales data

To compare traffic vs revenue trends.

87. How do you Create Blended Charts?

Steps:

Add a chart to the report. > In the Data panel, click Blend Data > Select multiple data sources > Choose the join key (common field) > Add dimensions and metrics.

Result → Chart displays combined data from multiple sources.

88. What is the Maximum Number of Data Sources that can be Blended in Looker Studio?

Looker Studio allows analysts to blend up to 5 different data sources in a single blended dataset.

These sources are combined using a common join key such as product ID, date, or campaign name.

Data blending enables analysts to compare metrics from multiple platforms in one chart.

However, using many sources can slow down report performance.

Therefore, analysts should blend only necessary datasets.

Example

You can blend:

Google Analytics data

Google Ads data

Sales database

CRM data

Marketing campaign data

To analyze marketing ROI in one dashboard.

89. What Happens if Join Keys Do Not Match in Data Blending?

When join keys do not match between datasets, Looker Studio cannot combine those records properly.

In such cases, the result may show null or empty values for some metrics.

This usually happens when the values in the join field are different between datasets.

To avoid this issue, analysts must ensure that the join key values are consistent and clean.

Proper data preparation is important before blending datasets.

Example

Dataset 1:

Product ID

101

Dataset 2:

Product ID

201

90. What is Report Sharing in Looker Studio?

Report sharing allows users to give access to other people to view or edit dashboards.

It works similarly to Google Docs sharing.

Permissions can be controlled based on user roles.

Reports can be shared via email, link, or organization access.

This makes collaboration easier for teams.

Example

A data analyst shares a dashboard with a marketing manager to review campaign performance.

91. What is the Difference Between Viewer and Editor Permissions?

Viewer Permission:

Can only view the dashboard.

Cannot modify charts or data sources.

Used for managers or stakeholders.

Editor Permission:

Can edit charts, filters, and data sources.

Can modify report layout and calculations.

Used by analysts or developers.

Practical Example

Manager → Viewer

Data Analyst → Editor

92. What is Embedding a Report?

Embedding allows a Looker Studio report to be displayed inside a website or application.

This helps organizations share dashboards publicly or internally.

The report appears as part of the webpage.

It allows users to interact with charts directly on the website.

Embedding improves accessibility for business users.

Example

A company embeds a sales dashboard on its internal company portal.

93. What is Scheduled Email Delivery?

Scheduled email delivery automatically sends dashboard reports via email at a specific time.

It helps stakeholders receive regular updates without opening the report manually.

Reports can be scheduled daily, weekly, or monthly.

This feature improves communication of business insights.

It is commonly used for KPI reporting.

Example

Every Monday morning, the system sends a weekly sales report to the management team.

94. What is Community Visualization?

Community visualization allows developers to create custom charts using JavaScript.

These visualizations extend Looker Studio beyond default chart options.

They are useful when standard charts cannot represent data effectively.

Community visualizations can be added to reports from external libraries.

They increase flexibility in dashboard design.

Example

A funnel chart created using community visualization to show conversion stages.

95. What is a Community Connector?

A community connector allows Looker Studio to connect with third-party data sources.

These connectors are built by developers outside Google.

They allow integration with platforms not supported by default connectors.

This expands the range of data sources available for analysis.

Many marketing platforms provide community connectors.

Example

Connect Looker Studio to:

Facebook Ads

LinkedIn Ads

Shopify

96. What is a Parameter in Looker Studio?

A parameter is a user-defined variable that allows dynamic user input.

It allows viewers to change calculations or filters in dashboards.

Parameters make reports more flexible and interactive.

They can be connected to calculated fields or controls.

Parameters help perform scenario analysis.

Example

Parameter allows users to select:

Revenue

Profit

The chart updates automatically based on the selected metric.

97. How Can You Optimize Dashboard Performance?

Performance optimization ensures dashboards load faster and work efficiently.

Analysts should minimize unnecessary charts and heavy queries.

Using aggregated datasets improves speed.

Data extraction and caching can reduce processing time.

Proper dashboard design improves user experience.

Example

Instead of loading 1 million rows, use a summarized dataset with totals.

98. What are Best Practices for Designing Dashboards?

Good dashboards focus on clear communication of insights.

Important KPIs should be displayed at the top.

Charts should be simple and easy to understand.

Consistent colors and labels improve readability.

Too many charts should be avoided to prevent confusion.

Example

Dashboard layout:

Top → KPI scorecards

Middle → trend charts

Bottom → detailed tables.

99. Why is Looker Studio Important for Data Analysts?

Looker Studio helps analysts convert raw data into visual insights.

It supports multiple data sources like Google Analytics, BigQuery, and spreadsheets.

Interactive dashboards help stakeholders make data-driven decisions.

Reports can be shared easily with teams.

It is widely used for business intelligence and reporting.

Example

A marketing analyst creates a dashboard showing:

Website traffic

Ad spend

Sales revenue

Management uses it to evaluate marketing performance.

100. What are Dimensions in Looker Studio?

Dimensions are categorical fields used to group data.

They describe the data rather than measure it.

They are used to break down metrics.

Example: Country, Product Name, Date.

101. What are Metrics in Looker Studio?

Metrics are numerical values that can be measured or aggregated.

They show quantities like totals, averages, or counts.

Metrics help analyze performance.

Example: Sales, Revenue, Users.

102. What is a Date Range Dimension?

A date range dimension defines the time field used for date filtering.

It allows charts to respond to date range controls.

Usually set as order date or event date.

Example: Sales data filtered by Order Date.

103. What is Conditional Formatting in Tables?

Conditional formatting highlights data based on conditions.

It uses colors to show high or low values.

Helps users quickly identify trends.

Example:

Sales > 1000 → Green

Sales < 500 → Red

104. What is Data Freshness?

Data freshness shows how recently the data source was updated.

It ensures reports display the latest data.

Some sources update automatically.

Example : Google Analytics updates data every few hours.

105 What is Extract Data Source?

Extract data creates a cached copy of the dataset inside Looker Studio.

It improves dashboard performance.

Useful when the original dataset is very large.

. What is Default Date Range?

Default date range defines the time period shown when the report opens.

Users can change it using date filters.

Example:

Default range = Last 28 days.

106. What is Resource Menu in Looker Studio?

The Resource menu manages data sources and report settings.

Analysts use it to edit connections or add calculated fields.

Common options:

Manage added data sources

Blend data